

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

The Paradox Entry Framework

*A Behavioral Constraint Architecture for
Diplomatic Engagement Under Strategic Ambiguity*

Version 1.5 (Sovereign Pivot) — May 2026

Calibrated for the US-Iran Negotiation Environment

With: 3 Core + 2 Supporting Facilitators | Human-in-the-Loop Protocol | Milestone Benefits | Elastic
Step-Back with Earn-Back | 24-Month Duration with Renewal

NEGOTIATION REFERENCE

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Preamble: The May 2026 Moment

As of 20 May 2026

"The single most important achievement is the agreement that Iran will never ever have nuclear material that will create a bomb."

— Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi, May 2026

The United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to a durable de-escalation since hostilities escalated in February 2026. Following six weeks of military confrontation, both parties have exhausted the escalation ladder and returned to the negotiating table, mediated by Pakistan and facilitated by Oman. A conditional ceasefire has held since early April. Yet the pathway to a sustainable arrangement remains fraught with structural obstacles that traditional diplomatic frameworks have repeatedly failed to overcome.

The central challenge is not a lack of workable technical solutions. It is the political cost of being seen to move first. In both capitals, any concession perceived as unilateral weakness risks domestic paralysis and hardliner mobilization. The history of the JCPOA — negotiated in good faith, implemented in compliance, then abandoned after an administration change — looms over every discussion. Trust, once lost, cannot be rebuilt through declarative promises alone.

What is needed is not another front-loaded treaty requiring simultaneous commitment to all outcomes in advance. What is needed is an architecture that allows both parties to signal readiness, pause escalation, and engage through layered channels without appearing to concede or commit prematurely. An architecture that treats ambiguity not as an obstacle to be eliminated, but as a manageable terrain to be navigated with precision.

The Paradox Entry Framework (PEF) offers such an architecture. It replaces the high-friction requirement of "doing something" with the lower-friction discipline of "refraining from doing something." It creates structured constraint bands within which both parties can move without crossing lines that would expose them politically. It makes compliance passive rather than performative. And it preserves the essential dignity of sovereign equals engaging not as adversaries or allies, but as states with legitimate interests that happen to conflict.

This document is calibrated for the May 2026 negotiation environment. It draws on established diplomatic practice, contemporary verification technology, and the structural lessons of past frameworks. It is designed to be circulated quietly, tested incrementally, and adopted only if it proves its worth in the field.

Implementer's Digest

A negotiator should grasp the entire framework in 10 minutes, not 2 hours. This digest provides the essentials.

What Each Party Must Not Do (Three Constraint Bands)

Table ES1: Prohibited Actions by Band

Band	Party A Must Not...	Party B Must Not...
I. Sovereign Presence	Declare formal intent to negotiate; make irreversible concessions	Declare formal intent to negotiate; make irreversible concessions
II. Calibrated Equilibrium	Escalate within the buffer zone; declare exclusion zones	Escalate within the buffer zone; declare exclusion zones
III. Distributed Engagement	Form a formal bloc; issue joint communiques	Form a formal bloc; issue joint communiques

What Happens if They Comply

- **Day 0:** Humanitarian credit line expands by 10% (reversible if window fails)
- **Day 14:** Framework activates. Stabilization Window opens. Civilian flows resume.
- **Day 30:** Milestone Benefit unlocks (credit line +15%). Automatic Confidence Milestones begin.
- **Day 90:** Maritime buffer may reduce. Detainee release possible.
- **Month 12:** Verification intensity automatically reduces if compliance clean.
- **Month 24:** Framework review and renewal decision.

What Happens if They Violate (Decision Tree)

Table ES2: Violation Response Guide

If...	Then...
One band breached	Reversible counter-measure in same domain. 48-hour cooling-off. Framework intact.
Two+ bands breached	Stabilization Pause. Benefits frozen. 72-hour Joint Review. MVC survives.
Proxy attack occurs	Tiered Attribution (A/B/C). 6-hour cautionary assessment. Circuit-breaker pauses economics. Political override possible.
Nuclear access without notice	Human-in-the-Loop Protocol: IAEA officer pauses → 3-expert panel confirms → foreign minister Political Hold → 14-day review.
Political shock at home	Automatic Continuity Pause (90 days, extendable to 180 days unilaterally). MVC continues. No breach penalties.

Who Facilitates What

Table ES3: Core Facilitating States at a Glance

State	What They Do	Can They Vote?
Oman	Host, maritime hotline, FIR	Yes
Switzerland	All finance, escrow, credit line	Yes
Pakistan	Crisis summits, backchannel, mediation	Yes
IAEA	Nuclear verification, encrypted logs	No (technical only)
Qatar	Maritime backup, detainee negotiation	No (technical only)

Bottom Line: Three rules, three facilitators, one relay system, and a survival core that outlasts everything. The rest is detail.

Section 1: Purpose and Core Philosophy

This section explains why a constraint-based architecture can succeed where linear frameworks have failed, and defines the structural principles that govern the entire framework.

1.1 Why Constraint-Based Architecture Works

Traditional diplomatic documents are linear, literal, rigid, and politically exposed. They demand explicit commitments at the outset. They require both parties to declare their positions in unambiguous language. They create winner-loser dynamics that make ratification difficult and reversal tempting. This Framework operates on different principles.

Modern diplomacy between adversaries has always functioned through:

- **Reversible steps** that can be undone without loss of face
- **Signals that can be interpreted through multiple domestic frames** that allow domestic audiences to interpret events favorably
- **Non-paper channels** that enable exploration without commitment
- **Face-saving ambiguity** that preserves political space for leaders
- **Parallel but asymmetric concessions** that create mutual benefit without symmetry of form

The PEF makes these informal practices explicit and structural. It transforms ambiguity from a diplomatic risk into a design feature. Each "neither X nor Y" condition functions not as a riddle to be solved, but as a *constraint band*: a bounded space of permissible action where calibrated signaling can occur without premature commitment.

This approach is particularly suited to the US-Iran context, where both parties must satisfy constituencies that regard any visible concession as capitulation. The framework allows each side to claim that it has conceded nothing fundamental while still creating the conditions for engagement.

What Makes This Approach Distinctive

If constructed correctly, the document becomes four things simultaneously:

A Boundary-Management Protocol. Each "neither X nor Y" becomes a calibrated boundary, not a logical puzzle. The boundaries are precise enough to be verified, yet flexible enough to permit creative interpretation.

A Creativity Test for Negotiators. It compels both sides to demonstrate that they can produce non-binary solutions to problems that have previously appeared zero-sum. The test is not of cleverness but of strategic maturity.

A Face-Saving Mechanism. Each boundary condition allows both sides to claim that they did not concede the core principle at stake. The domestic political cost of engagement is thereby reduced to manageable levels.

A Sequencing Tool. The constraint bands can function as entry conditions, mid-stream stabilizers, or exit ramps. They are not tied to any particular phase of negotiation. They are modular and reusable.

1.2 Structural Principles

Five principles govern the entire framework. Every provision must be consistent with all five.

Principle 1: Dual-Truth Signaling

Each party may take actions that are interpretable in two ways simultaneously. This allows domestic face-saving while enabling diplomatic movement. A step that appears as strength to a domestic audience may function as conciliation to the other party, and vice versa. Neither interpretation is more "true" than the other.

Principle 2: Reversibility

All early-stage steps must be reversible within a defined window. No party may be locked into a position from which it cannot retreat without political damage. Reversibility is not a sign of bad faith; it is a prerequisite for good faith in an environment of deep distrust.

Principle 3: Layered Presence

Engagement occurs simultaneously across informal, technical, and political channels without any single channel being declared "the negotiation." This prevents any one channel from becoming a hostage to events, and allows progress to continue in some channels even when others stall.

Principle 4: Non-Attribution

Early actions are not publicly attributed to concessions or shifts in policy. Steps are framed as technical adjustments, administrative routines, or operational necessities. Attribution occurs only when both parties agree that the time is right.

Principle 5: Constraint Over Commitment

Rather than dictating what parties must do, the framework codifies what they must not cross. Compliance is often passive — maintaining a boundary rather than taking an action. Inaction becomes progression.

Principle 6: No Precedent for Future Arrangements

Nothing in this framework, no action taken under it, and no compliance pattern established during its operation shall be cited by either party as binding precedent, legal admission, or waiver of sovereign position in any future negotiation, dispute, or international forum outside this framework. The framework exists solely for its own duration and creates no customary international law, no estoppel, and no legal expectation beyond its explicit terms.

Section 2: The Three Constraint Bands

The framework is organized around three constraint bands. Each band addresses a different dimension of the entry problem. Together they create a three-dimensional space within which diplomatic engagement can occur without premature exposure.

2.1 Band I: Sovereign Presence

Condition: Neither fully committed nor fully uncommitted.

Band I: Sovereign Presence Constraint Band

Operational Meaning: Each party must signal readiness to engage without making a formal declaration of intent. The signal must be perceptible to the other side but interpretable through multiple domestic frames.

Permitted Actions:

- Non-papers transmitted through third parties
- Quiet envoy deployment without official portfolio
- Technical consultations on narrow, non-political topics
- Reversible administrative steps (licensing waivers, transit authorizations)
- Reduction of rhetorical hostility in official communications

Prohibited Actions:

- Public declarations that negotiations are occurring
- Irreversible concessions of sovereignty or principle
- Formal signature of any binding instrument
- Acknowledgment of the other party's political demands as legitimate

The Boundary Resolution: A party satisfies this band by taking actions that are plausibly described as routine administrative matters or operational adjustments, while the cumulative pattern of those actions is perceptible to the other side as a signal of readiness. The signal exists in the eye of the beholder; the sender maintains deniability.

Practical Example: The United States issues a technical clarification to existing humanitarian licensing guidelines that has the practical effect of reducing processing delays for certain categories of medical equipment exports. The clarification is framed as an administrative update to OFAC guidance. Iranian procurement channels observe the reduced delays. Neither side has acknowledged any connection to broader diplomatic engagement. Yet the signal has been sent and received.

2.2 Band II: Calibrated Equilibrium

Condition: Neither escalating nor standing still.

Band II: Calibrated Equilibrium Constraint Band

Operational Meaning: Both parties reduce friction and create breathing room without framing those reductions as concessions or declaring them as de-escalation measures. The equilibrium is temporary, renewable, and explicitly not a final state.

Permitted Actions:

- Pausing certain operational activities without announcing the pause
- Allowing humanitarian or technical exceptions to proceed without obstruction
- Mutually ignoring minor infractions that would normally trigger protest
- Reducing operational tempo in theaters of potential friction
- Granting media access or travel permissions that had been withheld

Prohibited Actions:

- Publicly framing the other side's restraint as weakness or victory
- Demanding reciprocal steps before the window can open
- Declaring the establishment of a "new normal" or permanent arrangement
- Using the equilibrium as leverage in unrelated disputes

The Boundary Resolution: Both sides continue to operate in the same domains but at reduced intensity, creating a de facto de-escalation that neither party has acknowledged. The equilibrium is maintained by mutual forbearance rather than by agreement. Either side can resume prior activity without technically violating anything, because nothing was formally suspended.

Practical Example: Iranian naval forces continue patrol operations in the Strait of Hormuz but do not conduct close-proximity intercepts of commercial vessels. US naval forces continue presence operations but do not challenge Iranian patrol craft that remain beyond a certain distance from transit corridors. Insurance premiums for Hormuz transit begin to stabilize. Neither side announces any change in posture. The equilibrium exists in observable behavior, not in declared policy.

2.3 Band III: Distributed Engagement

Condition: Neither isolated nor formally aligned.

Band III: Distributed Engagement Constraint Band

Operational Meaning: Engagement occurs through multiple channels simultaneously, but no channel is declared the "official" one. Third parties facilitate without guaranteeing. Consultations occur without constituting a coalition.

Permitted Actions:

- Regional consultations with neighbors on topics of mutual concern
- Third-party facilitation of technical exchanges
- Direct technical talks on narrowly defined operational matters
- Informal political contact through back channels
- Parallel but non-linked discussions in multilateral forums

Prohibited Actions:

- Declaring any bilateral or multilateral format as exclusive or official
- Using external actors to pressure the other side publicly
- Forming a formal bloc or alliance structure
- Issuing joint communiques or coordinated public statements

The Boundary Resolution: Both parties are engaged through multiple overlapping channels, each of which is plausibly independent. The cumulative effect is structured engagement. The formal appearance is that no particular channel matters more than any other. The practical effect is that communication occurs reliably and verification is distributed.

Practical Example: Oman hosts technical discussions on maritime safety procedures. Switzerland facilitates financial channel discussions on humanitarian trade mechanics. The IAEA conducts its standard monitoring activities with enhanced transparency features. Pakistan provides high-level political relay between capitals. Each channel operates independently. None is declared part of a diplomatic process. Yet the parties are in structured communication across all channels simultaneously.

Section 3: Operational Mechanics of Constraint Bands

This section describes how the three constraint bands function in practice: how compliance is assessed, how violations are handled, and how the bands interact with each other.

3.1 Passive Compliance Verification

The framework uses a **passive compliance** model rather than an active certification model. In traditional frameworks, parties must actively demonstrate compliance through inspections, declarations, and reporting. In the PEF, compliance is often inferred from the absence of prohibited activity, verified through continuous remote monitoring rather than episodic inspection.

The logic is straightforward: if a centrifuge cascade is not spinning above the threshold, compliance is verified by telemetry. If a naval vessel does not cross the proximity buffer, compliance is verified by AIS tracking. If a banking channel processes transactions without interruption, compliance is verified by clearinghouse records. The party need not declare anything. The absence of prohibited activity speaks for itself.

Table 1: Passive vs. Active Compliance Models

Dimension		Traditional (Active)	PEF (Passive)
Verification method		Scheduled inspections, declarations	Continuous telemetry, absence monitoring
Party action required		Active demonstration of compliance	Refraining from prohibited activity
Political exposure		High — visible cooperation with inspectors	Low — no visible interaction required
Timeline		Episodic, scheduled	Continuous, real-time
Cost of compliance		High — administrative burden, sovereignty concerns	Low — behavioral restraint only

3.2 The Observation Window

Entry into the framework is triggered not by signature but by behavior. An initial **Symmetrical Observation Window** of 14 days is established (with optional accelerated activation after 72 consecutive hours by mutual consent). During this window, both parties must operate within all three constraint bands. If either party breaches any band during the window, the window resets. If both parties maintain compliance for the full 14 days, the framework activates automatically.

The 14-day window serves several functions. It tests intent without requiring explicit commitment. It creates a low-stakes environment in which either party can withdraw without having acknowledged participation. It respects military planning cycles. And it builds a behavioral foundation that subsequent phases can build upon.

3.3 Single-Band Breach Protocol

If one party violates a single constraint band:

- The violation is treated as a **technical misalignment**, not a collapse of the process
- The other party may respond with a **reversible counter-measure** limited to the same domain as the violation
- The framework remains intact unless **two or more bands are breached simultaneously**
- A mandatory 48-hour cooling-off period activates before any response

This prevents single incidents from derailing the entire architecture. The framework is resilient by design. Only a pattern of violations across multiple bands indicates systemic bad faith.

3.4 Multi-Band Breach Protocol

If two or more bands are breached simultaneously, or if a single-band breach is not remedied within seven days:

- The framework enters **Stabilization Pause** status
- All conditional benefits are frozen
- Core survival elements (ceasefire hotline, humanitarian access, emergency diplomatic channel) continue
- A Joint Review is convened within 72 hours
- The framework may be reconstituted if both parties affirm intent within 14 days

Section 8-bis: Proxy Attribution Architecture

When proxy forces conduct attacks during framework implementation, the pressure for rapid retaliation is immense. This section hardens the attribution process to prevent premature escalation while maintaining credible accountability.

8-bis.1 The Attribution Problem

The standard 48-hour Joint Forensic Board review is too slow under domestic political pressure. "Default non-attribution" feels naive when attacks produce casualties. The framework needs a graduated system that provides early clarity without premature judgment, and that manages the incentive structures that drive parties to rush attribution conclusions.

8-bis.2 Tiered Attribution Ladder

The binary "attributed / not attributed" framework is replaced with a three-tier system:

Table 8b1: Tiered Attribution Ladder

Tier	Confidence Level	Evidence Standard	Framework Response
Tier A (Confirmed)	High confidence (>90%)	Multi-source corroboration: signals intelligence, physical forensics, satellite imagery, and human intelligence all converge	Automatic framework retaliation authorized within the breached domain; Stabilization Pause in affected bands
Tier B (Circumstantial)	Medium confidence (60-90%)	Partial corroboration: two independent sources with consistent indicators but gaps in the chain of custody	Sanctions on the proxy group only (not the sponsoring state); expanded monitoring in the affected domain; 14-day enhanced review window
Tier C (Unclear)	Low confidence (<60%)	Single source, conflicting indicators, or plausible alternative explanations	Mandatory third-party mediation before any kinetic response; 48-hour cooling-off extension; no automatic economic triggers

Tier assignment is made by the Joint Forensic Board based on pre-defined evidence standards. The assignment is subject to appeal within 24 hours, during which no response action may be taken except defensive measures under Article 51 of the UN Charter.

8-bis.3 Real-Time Cautionary Attribution Protocol

Within 6 hours of any reported incident involving proxy forces, the Joint Forensic Board issues a **Cautionary Attribution Assessment**:

Table 8b2: Cautionary Attribution Timeline

Hour	Action	Binding Effect
T+0	Incident reported to facilitating state	None
T+2	Emergency hotline activated; both parties confirm receipt	Kinetic retaliation prohibited pending assessment
T+6	Cautionary Attribution Assessment issued (low/medium/high confidence)	If high confidence: human validation begins (see below). If medium/low: 48-hour standstill continues
T+8	Human Validation Layer (Tier A only)	High-confidence assessment transmitted to foreign ministers of three core facilitating states. Any one may request a 4-hour emergency review
T+12 (or T+16 if review requested)	Response authorization window opens (Tier A only)	If no review requested by T+12, response window opens. If review requested, extended to T+16
T+48	Final Tier assignment (A/B/C)	Corresponding framework response activates for all tiers

Both sides are legally barred from kinetic retaliation between T+2 and T+48 unless the Cautionary Attribution Assessment at T+6 is **high confidence** and the human validation layer at T+8 produces no requested review. In that case, a 12-hour (or 16-hour) final confirmation window opens before response authorization. This creates a minimum 18-hour cooling-off period even in the worst case, while providing political cover for leaders who face domestic pressure to "do something."

Human Validation Purpose: A purely automatic Tier A response could be triggered by a false alarm or a spoofed signal. The T+8 foreign minister review ensures that three real people with real political judgment confirm the assessment before authorizing kinetic response. Any one of the three can request a 4-hour pause for additional verification. This prevents catastrophic error while preserving speed.

8-bis.4 Economic Circuit-Breaker with Early Lift

During the 48-hour attribution window, all automated financial triggers are paused:

- The humanitarian credit line **continues processing** regardless of incident status
- No automated sanctions reimposition may activate during the window
- No trade corridor closures may be triggered by algorithmic responses
- Commercial contracts under the Private Sector Sanctity Shield remain protected

This removes the perverse incentive to rush attribution conclusions in order to unlock or prevent economic consequences. It separates the political-military timeline from the economic timeline, preventing one from driving the other. The circuit-breaker lifts upon Tier A or Tier B final assignment, or after 72 hours if the assessment remains Tier C.

Early Lift Option: The Joint Forensic Board may vote by simple majority to lift the circuit-breaker early if evidence clearly exonerates the accused party (e.g., a ship collision rather than an attack, a technical malfunction rather than a breach). This prevents the circuit-breaker from creating needless economic pain when the facts are obviously wrong. The early lift does not require a full Tier assignment; it simply restores normal economic operations pending the final attribution report.

8-bis.5 Spoiler Force Protocol

If a third-party actor (not under the direction of either principal party) conducts an attack designed to derail the framework:

- Default Tier C classification applies until evidence of principal direction is confirmed
- Both principal parties receive simultaneous notification of the spoiler designation
- Joint threat mitigation procedures activate automatically; bilateral penalties are deferred
- If either principal party assists in interdicting the spoiler force, that assistance is logged as a positive compliance indicator

8-bis.6 Political Override for High-Casualty Incidents

The Tiered Attribution Ladder is designed to be technocratic and deliberative. However, after an attack causing significant casualties, domestic political pressure may override procedural patience. To provide a release valve without encouraging its routine use, the framework includes a **conditional political override**:

If either party believes a Tier B or Tier C attack warrants accelerated response due to extraordinary circumstances, it may request an **Emergency Political Review** by the facilitating states. The request must be made within 6 hours of the incident and must specify the extraordinary circumstances justifying acceleration. Qualifying circumstances include:

- Attacks resulting in 10 or more confirmed fatalities
- Use of chemical, biological, or radiological weapons
- Deliberate targeting of clearly identified civilian installations (hospitals, schools, religious sites)
- Attacks on framework operational infrastructure (FIR, facilitating state personnel, IAEA monitoring teams)

If granted by a **two-thirds majority** of core facilitating states (2 of 3), the 48-hour cooling-off period is reduced to 12 hours. The requesting party may then take proportional kinetic response within the affected domain only. However, such acceleration counts as a **compliance debit** in the framework's public log: one accelerated response per 12-month period is permitted without penalty; a second acceleration in the same period triggers automatic Enhanced Review Protocol; a third triggers Stabilization Pause.

Intentional Friction: The override is deliberately difficult to obtain (two-thirds majority of neutrals required) and carries a visible cost (logged compliance debit). This ensures it is used only in genuinely extraordinary circumstances, not as a routine bypass of the attribution process. The facilitating states act as a deliberative brake on emotional escalation.

3.5 Band Interaction Matrix

The three bands operate as an integrated system. Progress in one band enables progress in others. Stagnation in one band does not necessarily block progress in the others.

Table 2: Band Interaction Matrix

If Band I Progresses...	Then Band II...	And Band III...
Signals of readiness exchanged	Can activate stabilization window	Can expand channel diversity
If Band II Progresses...	Then Band I...	And Band III...
Reduced friction observed	Can deepen signal intensity	Can formalize channel roles
If Band III Progresses...	Then Band I...	And Band II...
Multi-channel engagement active	Can broaden signal topics	Can extend stabilization scope

Section 4: The Facilitated Information Relay

One of the most politically sensitive aspects of engagement between adversaries is the appearance of direct communication. The FIR system solves this problem by enabling structured information exchange without direct bilateral contact.

4.1 Architecture

The FIR operates through a neutral host state — in the current context, the Sultanate of Oman. The host maintains a secure digital data repository containing two mirrored directories: one accessible only to Party A, one accessible only to Party B. There is no shared directory. The parties never communicate directly with each other through the portal.

Each party uploads operational data, compliance telemetry, maritime tracking arrays, and verification logs into its own isolated directory. The host's automated architecture synchronizes select data blocks into a single verification footprint that both parties can view in read-only form. Neither party can modify the other's data. Neither party can see who uploaded what — only the aggregated verification status.

4.2 The Mirror Effect

The parties are not negotiating together, nor are they negotiating apart. They are adjusting their behavior based on the mirrored data footprint left by the other side in the neutral digital space. Each party can see whether the cumulative indicators are trending toward compliance or away from it. Each party can calibrate its own actions accordingly. No direct message is required.

This creates what might be called **asynchronous mutual adjustment**: a process in which each side modifies its behavior based on observation of the other, without ever acknowledging that such observation is occurring. The adjustment is real. The acknowledgment is absent.

4.3 Information Categories

The FIR handles three categories of information:

Table 3: FIR Information Categories

Category	Content	Visibility
Green Data	Publicly available information (AIS feeds, IAEA reports, commercial shipping data)	Full aggregation, public dashboard
Amber Data	Operationally sensitive but not classified (telemetry pings, processing statistics)	Trend indicators only, no raw data
Red Data	Classified or politically sensitive (exact stockpile locations, military dispositions)	Compliance status only (<yes/no/unclear>)

4.4 Verification Without Visibility

The key design principle is **verification without visibility**. Each party verifies that the other is maintaining its constraint band commitments without obtaining information that could be used for military targeting or political leverage. The system is designed to answer one question only: Is the other party operating within the agreed constraint bands? The answer is binary. The reasoning is opaque.

Raw Data Protection: The FIR architecture is configured such that **no single state or entity has access to both sides' raw data simultaneously**. Raw data from each party is encrypted at source with a key held only by that party and the IAEA's independent verification module. The host state's automated system processes only hash-verified compliance indicators, not raw data. The host cannot read either party's operational data. The system answers one question only: "Is the other party operating within the agreed constraint bands?" It does not generate intelligence-valuable information about how, where, or when compliance is achieved. This turns a potential vulnerability (the host as an intelligence target) into a strength: not even the host can read the data.

4.5 Human Override

The automated system is supplemented by a human review mechanism. The Joint Forensic Board — composed of technical experts from neutral states — convenes within 48 hours of any automated alert. The Board determines whether an alert represents a genuine breach, a technical malfunction, or an ambiguous situation requiring diplomatic interpretation. Its findings are advisory, not binding, but they carry significant political weight because of the technical credibility of their composition.

Section 5: Four-Phase Sequencing Protocol

The framework unfolds in four phases. Each phase has distinct objectives, distinct timelines, and distinct exit criteria. Progression is not automatic; it requires verified completion of each phase before the next can activate.

5.1 Phase I: Silent Calibration

Phase I: Silent Calibration

Duration: 14-day Symmetrical Observation Window, with optional accelerated activation after 72 hours

Objective: Demonstrate that both parties can satisfy the three constraint bands simultaneously

Entry Trigger: Either party initiates through a pre-arranged signal to the facilitating state; staggered unilateral entry available (see below)

Verification: Continuous passive monitoring through the FIR

Success Criteria: 14 consecutive days of compliance across all three bands (or 72 hours with mutual accelerated activation)

Failure Response: Window resets; no political consequence; all pre-loaded benefits reversible

Phase I is the "test of intent." It requires no public acknowledgment, no formal communication, no visible diplomatic activity. Both parties simply operate within the constraint bands. If they can do so for the full window, the framework proceeds. If not, the window resets and can be reinitiated at any time.

5.1.0 Staggered Entry Option

To solve the "who starts first" problem even within Phase I, the framework provides a **staggered entry mechanism**:

- Party A may enter Band I (Sovereign Presence) **unilaterally** for a 24-hour period
- If Party B matches Band I compliance within that 24-hour window, the full 14-day clock starts for both parties
- If Party B does not match, Party A withdraws with zero penalty and zero exposure
- Either party may initiate the staggered entry; there is no predetermined first mover

Hardening Safeguards (Sovereign Pivot-compatible):

- The staggered entry option may be exercised **only once per 90-day period**
- The facilitating state **does not announce** the initiation or the withdrawal

- Withdrawal is processed **silently through the FIR** and is not observable to the public or to non-participating states

This preserves the "no one goes first" principle asymmetrically. The first mover takes a 24-hour risk that is fully reversible. The second mover gains the advantage of observing the first mover's behavior before committing. Both have political cover: the first mover can claim it was conducting an independent policy review; the second mover can claim it was responding to positive developments. The silent-processing safeguard prevents the political theater of a public "withdrawal" from being reported as weakness.

5.1.0-bis Accelerated Activation

Either party may propose **accelerated activation** after 72 consecutive hours of verified compliance. If the other party consents, the framework transitions directly to Phase II. If the other party does not respond within 12 hours, the proposal lapses and the full 14-day window continues.

To enable rapid execution without new orders, military commands receive **pre-positioned implementation playbooks** before the window opens. These playbooks contain standing instructions for each constraint band scenario, validated by legal and political authorities in advance. Commanders execute from the playbook; they do not wait for new orders. This respects military planning cycles while preserving the option for faster movement when both sides are ready.

The low stakes of Phase I are intentional. It allows parties to test the framework without political exposure. A failure in Phase I is not a diplomatic failure; it is simply a signal that the conditions are not yet ripe. The framework is designed to accommodate multiple Phase I attempts before success.

5.1.1 Front-Loaded Symbolic Concessions

The observation window risks feeling like diplomatic theater if it begins with zero tangible benefits. To overcome early cynicism and generate immediate momentum, the following **Hour Zero Pre-Commitments** activate simultaneously with the observation window:

Table 5a: Hour Zero Pre-Commitments

Action	Description	Framing
Prisoner Release	Each side releases one low-level detainee held on humanitarian grounds	Independent humanitarian gesture; not linked to broader process
Exercise Pause	Each side pauses one scheduled small-scale military exercise near the contact line	Operational scheduling adjustment; not a de-escalation measure
Humanitarian List Validation	Each side formally acknowledges the other's published humanitarian credit line eligibility list as valid for processing	Technical administrative clarification; not a sanctions policy change
Immediate Credit Line Expansion	Upon window initiation, the Swiss humanitarian credit line ceiling increases by 10% from its pre-window baseline for agricultural and medical transactions	Technical adjustment to liquidity parameters; reversible if window fails

These pre-commitments are deliberately calibrated. The prisoner release and exercise pause are symbolic but visible. The humanitarian list validation is practical but plausibly routine. The credit line expansion is tangible and immediate — it gives the receiving party a genuine economic benefit from Hour Zero, creating immediate stake in the process. All are reversible if the window fails to complete.

5.1.2 Use-It-or-Lose-It Rapid Confidence Measures

Within the first 24 hours of the observation window, either party may propose a **Zero-Cost Transparency Move** from a pre-negotiated menu. Acceptance triggers immediate expansion of the observation window from 72 to 120 hours. Decline carries no penalty but forfeits the extension opportunity.

Table 5b: Zero-Cost Transparency Menu

Move	Verification	Window Extension
Share 24-hour radar track data for a specified 50 km corridor	Commercial satellite corroboration	+24 hours (to 96 total)
Publish aggregate humanitarian transaction volumes for prior 30 days	Clearinghouse audit confirmation	+24 hours (to 96 total)
Allow single-site IAEA telemetry upgrade without additional access rights	IAEA technical confirmation	+48 hours (to 120 total)
Confirm proxy force stand-down order transmitted (not received, not complied with)	Signal intelligence corroboration by neutral party	+48 hours (to 120 total)

The transparency moves are designed to be reversible, verifiable, and plausibly routine. They test whether both parties can move beyond restraint into active confidence-building without exposing themselves.

5.1.3 Automatic Confidence Milestones

Before the observation window begins, facilitating states pre-negotiate a **Automatic Confidence Milestones**: a menu of off-ramp benefits that **presumptively unlock** at predefined milestones during the 14-day window. These benefits are not announced publicly. They unlock when telemetry confirms compliance **unless** either core facilitating state issues a Silent Hold within 6 hours of the milestone. A Silent Hold is logged confidentially but not made public. It does not prevent future benefits from unlocking at subsequent milestones.

Table 5c: Automatic Confidence Milestones (Illustrative)

Milestone	Auto-Unlock Benefit	Visibility
12 hours continuous compliance	Visa fast-lane authorization for technical personnel (12-day processing to 48 hours)	Internal administrative only
36 hours continuous compliance	Expansion of Swiss credit line ceiling by 15% for agricultural transactions	Commercial channels only
48 hours continuous compliance	Joint facilitating state statement welcoming "positive regional developments"	Public, attributed to facilitating state only
72 hours full completion	Framework Phase II auto-activation; first stabilization window opens	Public via facilitating state

The Automatic Confidence Milestones addresses the momentum problem directly. Instead of asking parties to maintain compliance for 14 days based on hope alone, it creates an internal reward curve that makes continued compliance feel progressively more valuable. The benefits are modest enough to avoid creating perverse incentives, but meaningful enough to sustain engagement.

5.2 Phase II: Stabilization Window

Phase II: Stabilization Window

Duration: 30-90 days, renewable by mutual consent

Objective: Create a sustained period of reduced friction in which trust can begin to accumulate

Entry Trigger: Successful completion of Phase I

Core Mechanism: Both parties operate under Band II (Calibrated Equilibrium) rules

Verification: FIR trend analysis plus independent observer reporting

Success Criteria: Stable or improving trend indicators across all domains for 30 consecutive days

Phase II is where the framework begins to generate tangible benefits. The stabilization window creates breathing room for civilian economic activity, humanitarian flows, and regional trade. Insurance markets respond to reduced risk. Commercial actors begin to plan based on the assumption that the equilibrium will hold. None of this requires any formal agreement.

During Phase II, the parties may begin to explore expanded cooperation through the FIR channels. Technical working groups on maritime safety, financial clearing, or nuclear safety can be convened without being labeled as "negotiations." Their output is technical, not political. Their recommendations are advisory, not binding. Yet the cumulative effect is the construction of working relationships and mutual familiarity.

5.3 Phase III: Structured Dialogue

Phase III: Structured Dialogue

Duration: Open-ended, subject to 90-day progress reviews

Objective: Address substantive issues through structured, multi-channel dialogue

Entry Trigger: Phase II stability indicators maintained for minimum 30 days

Core Mechanism: Issue-specific working groups operating through Band III channels

Verification: Working group output plus continued FIR compliance monitoring

Success Criteria: Concrete deliverables in at least one domain (nuclear, maritime, economic)

Phase III is where the framework transitions from behavioral management to substantive engagement. Issue-specific working groups are established on topics of mutual concern. Each working group operates within its own constraint band, applying the same constraint-band logic to its specific domain.

The working groups are not co-located. They meet in different venues, at different times, with different participants. Their outputs are transmitted through the FIR. This distributed structure prevents any single issue from derailing the entire process and allows progress to occur in one domain even when another domain is stalled.

5.4 Phase IV: Graduated Formalization

Phase IV: Graduated Formalization

Duration: Open-ended

Objective: Convert working understandings into formal arrangements at a pace both parties can accept

Entry Trigger: Phase III delivers concrete outcomes in at least two domains

Core Mechanism: Modular formalization of specific arrangements

Verification: Standard international verification mechanisms

Key Principle: Formalization is optional, not mandatory

Phase IV represents the point at which the Framework has served its purpose. If the process has reached this stage, both parties have demonstrated that they can cooperate across multiple domains. The constraint bands have been internalized as behavioral norms. Trust, while not complete, has reached a level where formal agreements become politically viable.

However, the framework explicitly does not require formalization. Some parties may prefer to continue operating under the Framework indefinitely, precisely because its informality preserves the flexibility and deniability that made engagement possible in the first place. The framework accommodates both paths.

Section 6: Elastic Reversibility and the Continuity Pause

The framework's resilience depends on its capacity to absorb shocks without collapsing. This section describes the mechanisms that ensure survival in the face of violations, political disruptions, and external crises.

6.1 The Elasticity Principle

Every component of the framework is designed with **elastic reversibility**: the capacity to snap back to a prior state when pressure is applied, and to resume the current state when pressure is released. This is not merely a safety feature. It is the core design philosophy.

The logic is rooted in the observation that diplomatic processes between adversaries do not fail because parties violate agreements. They fail because violations trigger automatic escalation sequences that neither party can control. The PEF breaks that sequence by making responses proportional, reversible, and temporally bounded.

6.2 Step-Back Elasticity Matrix

If an automated sensor or human observer detects a breach of a constraint band, the system does not declare a diplomatic crisis. Instead, the corresponding functional window temporarily narrows:

Table 4: Elastic Response Matrix

Band Breached	Immediate Response	Duration	Restoration Trigger
Band I: Sovereign Presence	Signal channel narrows; non-paper exchange pauses	48 hours	Compliance telemetry restored
Band II: Calibrated Equilibrium	Stabilization window freezes at current level	72 hours	Trend indicators stabilize
Band III: Distributed Engagement	Affected channel suspends; other channels continue	48 hours	Joint Forensic Board clears resumption
Multi-band simultaneous	Full Phase rollback to last stable state	7 days	Both parties affirm intent to continue

6.3 Minimum Viable Configuration

Under all circumstances, including total framework suspension, a **Minimum Viable Configuration** (MVC) survives automatically for 180 days. The MVC consists of three elements:

1. **Ceasefire Hotline:** The facilitated 24/7 bilateral hotline between military commanders remains active regardless of framework status. Neither party may disable the hotline without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2. **Humanitarian Access:** The zero-fee, no-inspection-delay humanitarian corridor for food, medicine, medical equipment, and UN supplies continues regardless of any dispute, breach, or suspension.

3. **Emergency Diplomatic Channel:** The backchannel through the facilitating state remains open for crisis communication and de-escalation regardless of formal diplomatic status.

The MVC operates under UN auspices as a standalone humanitarian arrangement. It is not contingent on any other provision. Even if both parties formally withdraw from the broader framework, the MVC continues for 180 days pending reconstitution efforts.

6.4 Continuity Pause

The framework includes an automatic **Continuity Pause** that activates when political events threaten to derail the process. If any of the following events occur in either party's jurisdiction, implementation automatically enters a **Continuity Pause** rather than terminating:

- National elections or referenda
- Leadership transition or incapacitation
- Cabinet collapse affecting negotiating ministries
- Mass protests affecting government authority
- Significant military incident affecting domestic politics

During a Continuity Pause, core survival elements continue unchanged. Conditional elements enter hold status. The facilitating state issues a Continuity Pause Certificate within 48 hours. The affected party has 30 days to confirm continuation, propose modifications, or request stabilization pause. If no response within 30 days, the Continuity Pause extends automatically. Initial maximum duration: 90 days. At the request of the affected party, the Continuity Pause may be extended by an additional 90 days **without requiring the other principal party's consent**. This unilateral extension right may be exercised once per Continuity Pause event. Beyond 180 days total, mutual consent is required for further extension.

Crucially, a Continuity Pause does **not** constitute material breach, does **not** trigger compliance penalties, and does **not** enable the other party to suspend its obligations. It is a protected pause, not a failure.

6.5 Force Majeure and External Crisis

If a natural disaster, pandemic, or third-party military action disrupts one party's capacity to maintain constraint band compliance, the following procedures apply:

- A **14-day obligation suspension** may activate upon certified force majeure declaration
- **Third-party certification required:** The force majeure claim must be certified by the WHO (for pandemics), the UN Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (for natural disasters), or a neutral technical panel appointed by the facilitating states (for cyber-related disruptions). Certification must be issued within 7 days of the claim.
- **Uncertified claims do not trigger suspension.** If certification is not issued within 7 days, the party must resume full compliance or enter the standard breach protocol.
- Extension to an additional 14 days (28 days total) available with renewed certification
- Maximum suspension duration: 28 days regardless of circumstances

- No compliance penalties accrue during certified suspension
- Humanitarian and emergency channels continue uninterrupted

Anti-Abuse Safeguard: Self-declared "cyber pandemics" or other uncertified disruptions do not trigger automatic suspension. The requirement for independent third-party certification prevents strategic abuse of the force majeure provision.

6.6 Milestone Benefits Table: Positive Reciprocity Mechanism

The framework's **conditional reversion** mechanism is excellent at punishing violations, but it needs a corresponding mechanism for **rewarding sustained exceptional cooperation**. The Milestone Benefits Table provides this upward ratchet:

Table 6a: Milestone Benefits Table: 30-Day Milestone Benefits

Milestone	Benefit Unlocked	Visibility	Reversibility
30 days multi-band compliance	Credit line ceiling enlarged by 15% for agricultural transactions	Commercial channels only	Reversible if compliance drops below threshold for 14+ days
60 days multi-band compliance	Maritime proximity buffer reduced from 500 yards to 400 yards (reduced friction, not reduced security)	Operational only; no public announcement	Automatically reverts to 500 yards if any band breached
90 days multi-band compliance	Release of one additional low-level detainee by each party	Public, as independent humanitarian gesture	Future goodwill credits may be withheld if compliance drops
120 days multi-band compliance	Expansion of permissible credit line categories to include civilian aviation parts and spare parts	Administrative notice only	Reversible with 30-day notice
180 days multi-band compliance	Joint facilitating state statement acknowledging "sustained constructive engagement"	Public, attributed to facilitating states only	Statement stands but future similar statements withheld if compliance drops

Accumulation Rules: Benefits are cumulative and non-expiring as long as compliance is maintained. If compliance drops, benefits accumulated at or below the current compliance duration are preserved. Benefits above the current duration are suspended (not forfeited) and may be reactivated if compliance recovers. This creates an upward staircase: each step gained is a platform that makes reversal more costly.

Transparency: The benefit menu is pre-negotiated before the framework activates but is not publicly announced. Benefits unlock as surprises, creating positive momentum without creating public expectations that could become political liabilities.

Section 7: Parallel Public Characterization Protocol

This section addresses how multiple public characterizations of the same observable behavioral constraints can be simultaneously factually sustainable. It is not a license to deceive. It is a mature recognition that different political systems — democratic and revolutionary alike — require different emphasis to sustain public support for the same practical behavioral constraints.

7.1 The Characterization Problem

Every diplomatic framework between adversaries faces a characterization problem. Each party must explain its participation to a domestic audience that regards the other side with suspicion or hostility. If the framework requires both parties to describe it in the same terms, at least one party will face a characterization that is politically unsustainable at home.

The Framework solves this problem not by imposing a common narrative but by recognizing that the constraint bands generate outcomes that admit of different truthful emphases. Each party may describe the process in terms that serve its domestic political needs, because the behavioral constraints are real and the outcomes they produce are observable by both sides. No party is required to adopt the other's characterization. Neither characterization is more "factual" than the other; they emphasize different dimensions of a shared behavioral reality.

7.2 Illustrative Permissible Emphases (Non-Exhaustive)

Important: The following statements are examples of factually sustainable characterizations of the same behavioral constraints. Neither list is exhaustive. Neither list was negotiated. Each party arrives at its own characterization independently, and the framework imposes no obligation to adopt, endorse, or refrain from criticizing the other party's characterization.

Illustrative Permissible Emphases — Party A

These characterizations emphasize *continuity of legal and military posture*:

- "Maximum structural leverage remains fully locked in place."
- "The adversary's most dangerous capability has been neutralized under international containment."
- "Our maritime posture remains uncompromised."
- "No irreversible concessions have been made."
- "We are managing a situation, not making a deal."

Illustrative Permissible Emphases — Party B

These characterizations emphasize *absence of irreversible commitment*:

- "Sovereign control over national territory and infrastructure remains absolute."
- "Not a single gram of strategic material has left our soil."
- "Resistance diplomacy has successfully protected national interests."
- "No binding commitments to the adversary have been entered."
- "We are observing a pause, not accepting terms."

Why Both Are True: Party A's characterization emphasizes the *continuity* of its legal and military posture. Party B's characterization emphasizes the *absence of irreversible commitment*. Neither emphasis is false. Neither party has made an irreversible concession. Neither party has signed a binding instrument. Neither party has acknowledged the legitimacy of the other's demands. The behavioral constraints are real and verifiable, but they are framed as operational management, not diplomatic concession. A US official can say: "Iran emphasizes absence of commitment; we emphasize continuity of leverage. Both are true. That is fine."

7.3 The Yellow/Red Card System for Escalatory Rhetoric

While divergent narrative framing is protected, deliberately escalatory rhetoric designed to provoke the other party is managed through a graduated warning system:

Table 5: Rhetorical Escalation Management

Level	Trigger	Response	Consequence
Yellow Card	First escalatory statement by head of state, foreign minister, or military chief per 90-day window	Private written notice from facilitating state	Zero framework penalty; diplomatic courtesy only
Red Card	Second escalatory statement within same 90-day window	Publicly logged in framework cycle report	Minor compliance notation; no automatic penalty
Third Offense	Third escalatory statement within same 90-day window	Mandatory Communication within 48 hours	Joint Window Structured diplomatic engagement required

The Yellow/Red Card system explicitly excludes legislators, former officials, media commentators, and civil society. The framework recognizes that democratic politics generates rhetorical heat that does not represent official policy. Only statements by the highest executive and military authorities are subject to this regime.

7.3 Functional Diplomatic Actors and Differential Weights

7.3.1 Expanded Coverage: Functional Diplomatic Actors

The original Yellow/Red Card definition excludes too many officials who make de facto diplomatic statements. The hardened framework expands coverage to **Functional Diplomatic Actors**: any official who has independently attended a G7, G20, or UN Security Council meeting in an official capacity within the past 18 months. This captures intelligence chiefs, cabinet members, and senior advisors without including random backbenchers.

Table 7a: Rhetoric Coverage by Official Category

Category	Covered?	Card Type	Scope
Head of state, head of government, foreign minister, defense minister, military chiefs of staff	Yes	Yellow/Red	All statements referencing the framework or the other principal party
Functional Diplomatic Actors (G7/G20/UNSC attendees within 18 months)	Yes	Yellow/Red	Statements explicitly referencing framework implementation
Legislators on the Democracy-Specific Carve-In list (3 per side)	Yes	Yellow/Red	Rhetoric referencing the framework only
Committee chairs, spokespersons, governors, mayors with national platforms	Partial	Orange (see below)	Statements likely to be interpreted as official policy signals
Ordinary legislators, former officials, media, civil society	No	None	Free speech; non-binding designation applies

7.3.2 Airtime Equivalence Rule

If a head of state publicly praises, endorses, condemns, or disavows a statement by a non-covered official (e.g., a senator or governor), that statement is **retroactively covered** as if the head of state had made it themselves. This creates a powerful incentive for leaders to disavow proxy rhetoric before it generates framework consequences.

The rule applies when the head of state's response is made within 48 hours of the original statement. After 48 hours, the retroactive coverage window closes. A non-covered official's statement that receives no head-of-state response within 48 hours is flagged as "non-binding" and excluded from card accumulation.

7.3.3 Differential Card Weights

The hardened system introduces an **Orange Card** tier for officials with significant platforms who are not fully covered:

Table 7b: Differential Card Weight System

Card	Trigger	Penalty	Conversion Rule
Yellow	First offense by covered official per 90-day window	Private written notice only; zero WBI	Two yellows in one window = red
Red	Second yellow-equivalent offense in same 90-day window	Publicly logged; minor compliance notation	Third red-equivalent = mandatory Joint Communication Window
Orange (NEW)	Escalatory statement by non-covered official with significant platform	Logged in framework cycle report; no automatic conversion	Three orange cards on the same side within 30 days are logged as a pattern. The facilitating states may, by majority vote, treat repeated orange-card incidents as a pattern of indirect escalation and issue a private warning to the head of state

7.3.4 Democracy-Specific Carve-In

For parties with democratic systems of government, each side nominates three legislators who are treated as covered officials for framework-specific rhetoric:

- **One** from the majority party or coalition
- **One** from the largest opposition party
- **One** from a security or foreign affairs committee (either party)

These three legislators are the only legislators whose framework-related rhetoric accumulates cards. All other legislators are free to speak without restriction. Their statements are automatically flagged as "non-binding" in the framework record. This carve-in acknowledges that in democratic systems, certain legislators have genuine policy influence while the vast majority do not.

7.4 Characterization Convergence

Over time, if the framework proves successful, the two characterization tracks may naturally converge. Statements that began as "we are managing a situation" may evolve into "we are exploring possibilities." This evolution is not mandated by the framework. It emerges organically from the accumulation of positive experience.

The framework does not require either party to ever acknowledge convergence. But it creates the structural conditions under which convergence becomes possible. That is the most that any architecture can realistically achieve between adversaries.

7.5 Affirmative Transparency Statement

Nothing in this section authorizes either party to make factually false statements about the framework's operational provisions, verification data, or compliance status. The parallel characterization protocol permits divergent *emphasis* and *framing* of shared facts. It does not permit deliberate misrepresentation of material

compliance status, verification outcomes, or breach determinations.

Any statement that falsely claims a breach occurred when telemetry shows no breach, or falsely claims compliance when a breach has been confirmed, falls outside the protection of this section and may be treated as a Yellow Card offense under Section 7.3.

Why This Matters: This provision transforms a potential vulnerability into a defense. Critics may claim that the framework "allows lying." The response is clear: "We did not authorize lying. We authorized different emphasis on the same truth. Deliberate misrepresentation of compliance is a punishable offense." The distinction between *framing* (which is protected) and *fabrication* (which is not) is both legally defensible and politically essential.

Section 8: Verification Architecture

Verification in the Framework operates differently from traditional arms control verification. It is designed to answer a narrower question with lower political cost and higher temporal resolution.

8.1 Verification Philosophy

Traditional verification asks: "Is the other party fully complying with all provisions of the treaty?" This is a comprehensive question that requires comprehensive access. It creates political resistance because it implies broad intrusion into sovereign affairs.

PEF verification asks a narrower question: "Is the other party operating within the agreed constraint bands?" This is a bounded question that can be answered through targeted technical means. It requires no declarations, no inspections, no document exchanges. It relies on passive observation of behavior.

8.2 The Core Triad

Verification operates through three independent channels, known as the **Core Triad**:

1. **Remote Telemetry:** Continuous automated monitoring of key indicators (centrifuge operation parameters, naval vessel positions, financial clearing activity) transmitted in real-time to the facilitating state
2. **Independent Observation:** Neutral-state personnel physically present at key locations who report observable behavioral patterns without requiring access to classified information
3. **Commercial Data Fusion:** Analysis of commercially available data (shipping manifests, insurance records, commodity prices, satellite imagery) that provides indirect indicators of compliance

No single channel triggers a compliance determination. All three channels must converge before a breach is formally noted. If channels disagree, the Joint Forensic Board determines whether the discrepancy represents a genuine breach, a technical error, or an ambiguous situation requiring diplomatic interpretation.

8.3 Dual-Key Mechanisms

For high-sensitivity applications, the framework employs **dual-key mechanisms** that require the concurrence of both a neutral technical authority and the host state. The classic application is physical containment of sensitive materials:

A financial clearing account is placed under an automated dual-key digital lock. One key is held by the facilitating state's escrow administrator. One key is held by the host state's central bank representative. The system processes transactions only when both keys are present. Neither key-holder operates the transaction system; both provide authorization and verification. Either key-holder can block a transaction. Both must concur to release funds.

This arrangement satisfies two requirements simultaneously: the neutral authority obtains the assurance it needs, and the host state retains sovereign control over its territory and materials. Neither side is fully satisfied, which is the definition of a workable compromise.

8.4 Privacy-Preserving Monitoring

The framework incorporates privacy-preserving features that protect industrial and military secrets unrelated to the constraint band compliance:

- **Data Filtering at Source:** Only compliance-relevant data is transmitted. Raw operational data remains with the host.
- **Dual-Key Encryption:** All transmitted data is encrypted such that neither party can decrypt it alone. Only the facilitating state can decrypt, and only for the purpose of generating aggregated compliance indicators.
- **Compliance-Only Output:** The IAEA and other verification bodies receive only compliance status data, not industrial process data or military operational details.

8.5 The Verification Confidence Threshold

The framework does not aim for perfect verification. It aims for **sufficient verification**: a level of confidence that makes breakout or cheating detectable within a time frame that permits response. The exact threshold varies by domain:

Table 6: Verification Confidence Thresholds (Tiered)

Domain		Confidence Target	Detection Timeline	Method
Nuclear sites)	(declared)	95%+ certainty	Within 24 hours	Continuous telemetry + encrypted log anchors
Nuclear sites)	(undeclared)	80% confidence	Within 7 days	Environmental sampling + commercial imagery + intelligence fusion
Nuclear timeline)	(breakout)	90% confidence	72 hours (detection) + 96 hours (response window)	Combined declared-site and undeclared-site indicators
Maritime proximity		99%+ certainty	Within 1 hour	AIS + satellite + independent observation
Financial channels		90%+ certainty	Within 72 hours	Banking records + independent audit
Communication patterns		Qualitative trend assessment	Within 7 days	FIR transmission analysis

Explicit Framework Acknowledgment: The framework does not guarantee 24-hour detection of a covert site. It guarantees detection of a breakout attempt from declared stockpiles within 72 hours, with high-confidence attribution within 7 days. This is an honest assessment of verification capabilities and is still operationally useful: a 72-hour detection window plus a 96-hour response window provides sufficient time for diplomatic and economic measures to activate before military significance is achieved.

8.6 Nuclear Domain Hardening

The 60% HEU host-managed containment described in Section 9.1.2 relies on sustained trust in a neutral technical authority — trust that is brittle and historically fragile. This section hardens the nuclear verification architecture through three technical mechanisms that distribute trust, raise detection certainty, and create reversible but detectable physical neutralization.

8.6.1 Remote-Monitored, Host-Managed Containment

Critical Design Principle: The framework does not require foreign or neutral parties to hold keys that can physically block a sovereign state's access to its own materials. Such a requirement is politically explosive and likely a red line for the host state. Instead, verification is achieved through **remote monitoring with host-managed physical control**.

The 60% HEU remains under **exclusive Iranian physical control** at all times. The storage facility is fitted with tamper-evident seals and continuous telemetry that broadcasts to the Core Triad verification channels. To access the material, Iran must provide **14 days' advance notice**, during which the IAEA may conduct a pre-access inspection. No foreign key-holder can block access. Rather, access without the required advance notice triggers **presumptive** economic consequences under the economic constraint band. The presumption activates within 24 hours unless the Joint Financial Review, by majority vote of the three core facilitating states, determines that the access was technical, involuntary, or de minimis. The presumption places the burden of proof on the non-breaching party to show why conditional reversion should proceed, not on the breaching party to show why it should not.

Verification Chain:

- **Tamper-Evident Seals:** Physical seals on all storage containers broadcast continuous status to the Core Triad. Any breach attempt is detectable within hours.
- **Blockchain-Anchored Telemetry:** All sensor data is hashed and anchored to a public permissionless encrypted log visible to all NPT states parties (detailed in 8.6.2).
- **Pre-Access Notification:** Any access to the material requires 14 days' advance notice (7 days for routine access, 48 hours for urgent safety access). Access without notice triggers **presumptive** economic response subject to human-in-the-loop review (8.6.8).
- **Pre-Access Inspection:** During the 14-day notice period, the IAEA may conduct a technical inspection to verify seal integrity and material accounting.
- **Post-Access Reporting:** Within 48 hours of any access, the host state must file a technical report with the Core Triad explaining the purpose and outcome.

Constraint Logic: The host state retains exclusive physical control. The constraint is **reputational and economic**, not physical. Unauthorized access triggers presumptive consequences that make breakout cost-prohibitive. This aligns with the host state's actual red lines while preserving the framework's deterrent effect — functionally equivalent to joint control, structurally unilateral.

Notice Period Differentiation (Change 13): To balance verification needs with operational reality, the framework distinguishes between routine and significant access:

Table 8n: Access Notification Requirements

Access Type	Advance Notice	IAEA Role	Trigger
Routine (seal inspection, maintenance, safety check)	7 days	Visual inspection only; no sampling	Normal operations
Significant (material withdrawal, reconfiguration, transfer)	14 days	Full managed access with material accounting	Material movement
Urgent (safety, sabotage, natural disaster)	48 hours	Safety verification only (see 8.6.6)	Emergency only

The 7-day notice for routine access acknowledges that the host state will need to enter the facility for legitimate maintenance. It is still restrictive enough to prevent surprise breakout. The 14-day notice for material removal prevents diversion while remaining shorter than the detection-to-response timeline.

8.6.2 IAEA-Managed Tamper-Evident Telemetry

The storage facility is fitted with a network of environmental and physical sensors (temperature, radiation, vibration, motion, pressure) that stream data continuously. Sensor data is encrypted and stored on **IAEA-managed servers with independent backup in Switzerland**. Hash values are provided to both parties and to all NPT states parties via a secure IAEA portal. The IAEA certifies data integrity monthly. Any party may request an independent forensic audit of the logs.

- **Broadcast Scope:** Hash summaries are visible to all NPT states parties via the IAEA portal. Any tampering event is globally visible within minutes.
- **Immutability:** Once logged, historical data cannot be altered without detection. The encrypted log system provides a permanent, auditable record of facility status.
- **Privacy Preservation:** Raw sensor data remains encrypted and accessible only to the Core Triad. NPT states parties receive only hash values and compliance status summaries.
- **Cost Escalation:** Any attempt to breach the facility generates a permanent, timestamped record distributed across multiple jurisdictions. This dramatically raises the reputational cost of breakout.

The IAEA already has the mandate, expertise, and institutional trust for this role. Using existing IAEA infrastructure avoids the political objections and technical complexity of introducing novel technology into a diplomatic framework.

8.6.3 Pre-Positioned Reversible Neutralization

Rather than demanding irreversible blending down of 60% HEU material — a step Iran has consistently rejected as politically impossible — the framework employs **reversible neutralization** through physical form conversion:

- The 60% HEU is fabricated into **mixed-oxide (MOX) fuel pins** at a declared facility under continuous Core Triad monitoring
- Each fuel pin is fitted with a **tracking collar** containing a unique identifier, a radiation signature sensor, and a tamper-evident seal
- The pins are stored in a standard fuel pin rack configuration under continuous Core Triad monitoring with tamper-evident seals and IAEA-managed encrypted telemetry
- Conversion back to weapons-usable form would require: (a) removal from monitored storage, (b) dissolution of the MOX matrix in a high-energy chemical process, (c) isotopic re-enrichment — each step visible and time-consuming

Detection Timeline: The full reversal process would require approximately 3-4 weeks of visible, high-energy processing. During that time, IAEA-managed encrypted sensors would detect vibration and radiation anomalies. The 14-day advance notification requirement for any access to the material provides additional warning time. And commercial satellite imagery would detect thermal signatures from the processing facility. The combination creates a detection-to-breakout window that satisfies the verification confidence threshold for the nuclear domain.

8.6.4 Explicit Non-Interference Principle for Nuclear Materials

The framework formally incorporates the following principle:

*"No foreign or neutral party shall hold a key, physical or digital, that can block a sovereign state's access to its own nuclear materials located on its own territory. Verification is achieved through remote monitoring, advance notification, **presumptive** consequence triggers (with facilitating state override), and reputational accountability. The host state retains exclusive physical control at all times. The constraint is economic and diplomatic, not mechanical."*

This principle is non-negotiable for host state acceptance. It reflects the operational reality that any framework requiring foreign parties to physically control another state's strategic materials will face insurmountable sovereignty objections. The PEF achieves equivalent verification confidence without crossing this line.

8.6.5 Conditional Review of Intrusive Verification After 12 Months

To address concerns that the verification arrangements described in this section are excessively intrusive, the framework includes a **conditional review provision**:

After 12 months of continuous Phase II operation, the physical containment arrangements for 60% HEU shall be subject to a mandatory Joint Review. If the IAEA has reported no compliance breaches during that 12-month period, both parties may agree to transition to less intrusive verification modalities. The advance notification period may be reduced. The monitoring frequency may be decreased. The encrypted log anchor may be simplified.

Any reduction in verification intensity requires: (a) IAEA certification of 12 months of clean compliance, (b) mutual consent of both principal parties, (c) confirmation by the facilitating states that regional security conditions support reduced monitoring. If any of these conditions is not met, the existing verification modalities

continue unchanged.

Automatic Reduction: After 12 months of continuous clean compliance, verification intensity **automatically** reduces to the next lower tier unless either principal party objects within 30 days. Objection must state specific compliance concerns. If no objection, the reduced regime applies for the following 12 months. This creates an incentive structure the host state can trust: sustained compliance produces tangible reductions in intrusion without requiring the other side's permission. The objection right protects the other party if compliance was not actually clean.

This provision gives the party seeking tighter control a path to more intrusive arrangements if compliance is poor, and gives the host state a path to reduced intrusion if compliance is good. It is a performance-based calibration mechanism, not an expiration date. The review is the reward for sustained compliance.

8.6.6 Mutual Urgent Access for Safety or Sabotage

If either party believes that urgent access to the 60% HEU storage facility is necessary to prevent a safety incident, sabotage, or natural disaster damage, it may request **accelerated access** with 48 hours' notice. The IAEA must be permitted to observe, but pre-access inspection is limited to safety verification only, not material accounting.

Qualifying circumstances include: fire, flood, earthquake, equipment malfunction threatening containment, credible threat of sabotage by third parties, or detection of radiation leakage. The requesting party must provide a written safety justification to the Core Triad within 4 hours of the access request.

Without this provision, a small fire or flood could force the host state to violate the 14-day notice rule to protect safety, which would trigger presumptive economic consequences for a non-proliferation reason. This provision prevents that perverse outcome while maintaining verification through IAEA observation.

8.6.7 No-Intelligence-Collection Clause

All IAEA access under this section is limited to nuclear verification purposes. The IAEA and its designated inspectors shall not collect, retain, or transmit intelligence unrelated to the 60% HEU containment and enrichment cap. This prohibition includes:

- Military facility design, layout, or defensive architecture
- Personnel identities, movements, or organizational charts outside the nuclear program
- Industrial or commercial activities unrelated to the nuclear fuel cycle
- Communications systems, electronic signatures, or cyber infrastructure

Enforcement: Any inspector found to have engaged in unauthorized intelligence collection shall be permanently removed from the framework. The host state may request a 90-day suspension of all inspections pending IAEA internal review. The IAEA must report findings within 30 days. Repeated violations may result in permanent restriction of IAEA access to declared sites only, with alternative verification methods (commercial satellite imagery, environmental sampling) filling the gap.

Rationale: The host state's deepest concern about IAEA access is that it serves as cover for intelligence gathering by states with which it has adversarial relationships. A binding prohibition with consequences directly addresses that concern. This is the kind of provision that can turn a red line into a yellow line.

8.6.8 Human-in-the-Loop Escalation Protocol for Nuclear Access Violations

The current framework relies on automated telemetry and advance notice requirements. But who *decides* if notice was properly given? Who *decides* if the IAEA inspection was obstructed? These decisions cannot be left to automated triggers or post-facto review alone. This protocol establishes a **human validation chain** with three independent actors, any two of whom can pause escalation.

Step 1: Detection Layer (Automated, T+0 to T+15 minutes)

Telemetry detects an unscheduled access attempt (no valid notice filed). An automated alert is sent within 15 minutes to:

- IAEA Duty Officer (Vienna)
- Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs Crisis Cell (Bern)
- Omani FIR Administrator (Muscat)

Step 2: Human Validation — First Check (T+0 to T+2 hours)

The IAEA Duty Officer makes an initial determination: *"Is this a genuine probable breach, a technical error, or a safety emergency?"*

- If **technical error or safety emergency** → Officer flags "pause." Framework compliance clock freezes. No conditional reversion. Joint Forensic Board convenes within 24 hours to investigate.
- If **genuine probable breach** → Officer escalates to Step 3.

Human Role: A single IAEA officer (rotating, trained, with clear written criteria) has the power to pause escalation for 24 hours. This prevents false alarms from triggering crisis.

Step 3: Human Validation — Second Check (T+2 to T+8 hours)

The IAEA Director General (or designated deputy) convenes an **Emergency Technical Panel** of three senior inspectors (not the same as the Joint Forensic Board). The Panel reviews telemetry, seal status, and any communication from the host state. The Panel votes: *"Breach confirmed"* (requires 2 of 3) or *"Breach not confirmed — further review needed."*

- If **not confirmed** → Framework continues. Host state may request expedited technical review.
- If **confirmed** → Escalation proceeds to Step 4.

Human Role: A small, expert panel makes a deliberative judgment, not an automated one. Their identity is known to both parties in advance, creating accountability.

Step 4: Political Hold Layer (T+8 to T+24 hours)

Confirmed breach notification is transmitted to the foreign ministers of the three core facilitating states and the other principal party (privately, not publicly). **Any one** of the three facilitating state foreign ministers may issue a **Political Hold** — a 48-hour freeze on all economic and diplomatic responses. A Political Hold can be issued for any reason (e.g., "we are negotiating a face-saving return to compliance," "we suspect spoofing," "we need time to verify"). If no Political Hold is issued within 8 hours of Step 3 confirmation, conditional reversion of sanctions and other framework responses activate.

Human Role: Three foreign ministers (real people with real political judgment) have unilateral veto power over escalation. This is the ultimate human-in-the-loop. It ensures that no automated sensor or technical panel can force a crisis without political leaders agreeing.

Step 5: Post-Event Review (T+72 hours to T+14 days)

The Joint Forensic Board conducts a full review, including the host state's explanation. If the breach was involuntary, technical, or a false alarm, all penalties are reversed retroactively and the compliance record is cleared. If the breach was deliberate, penalties stand and the host state accrues a compliance debit.

Human Role: Retroactive correction ensures that even if Steps 1–4 produce a mistaken escalation, it can be undone without permanent damage.

Table 8h: Why This Method Works

Requirement	How Met
Speed	Automated detection at T+0; human checks nested within 2-8-24-hour windows
False alarm protection	Single IAEA officer can pause at T+0
Deliberative judgment	3-inspector panel confirms breach before escalation
Political control	Any facilitating state foreign minister can issue Political Hold
Retroactive correction	Joint Forensic Board can reverse penalties within 14 days
No single point of failure	Three independent human actors (officer, panel, ministers)
Accountability	Names are known to both parties in advance

Section 9: Application to the US-Iran Context

This section applies the Framework to the specific circumstances of the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran as of May 2026. It translates the abstract architecture into concrete, actionable constraint bands tailored to the current negotiation environment.

9.1 Nuclear Constraint Band

Constraint Formulation: The material is neither removed nor fully accessible.

The nuclear dimension is the most sensitive and technically complex. The core challenge is that the United States requires verifiable assurance that Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile cannot be weaponized, while Iran cannot accept conditions that appear to disarm it or surrender sovereign control over its nuclear program.

9.1.1 The Constraint

Iran maintains a strict operational cap of 3.67% U-235 enrichment for all active centrifuge cascades fed with fresh UF₆ gas. No cascades are configured, re-networked, or adjusted to generate higher assay values. Existing canisters containing 60% highly enriched uranium remain physically in place but are stored in a specialized, ground-level facility under host-managed containment with continuous Core Triad monitoring, tamper-evident seals, and IAEA-managed encrypted telemetry.

9.1.2 The Boundary Resolution

The 60% HEU material does not leave Iranian soil, satisfying Iran's sovereignty requirement. Simultaneously, the material is placed under continuous Core Triad monitoring with tamper-evident seals and IAEA-managed encrypted telemetry, satisfying the US verification requirement. Access requires 14 days' advance notice with pre-access inspection rights. The material is functionally neutralized from a military planning perspective while remaining physically present from a sovereignty perspective.

9.1.3 Verification

Continuous passive digital monitoring via the Core Triad. Any unauthorized change in telemetry, physical disturbance, or enrichment detection above 3.67% triggers the Elastic Response Matrix within 15 minutes. The corresponding economic and transit windows temporarily narrow until compliance is restored.

9.1.4 Elastic Response

Breach of the nuclear constraint band triggers immediate freeze of the corresponding stabilization window. The Swiss humanitarian credit line temporarily locks. The Joint Forensic Board convenes within 24 hours. If the breach is verified as deliberate, the framework rolls back to the last stable state.

9.2 Maritime Constraint Band

Constraint Formulation: Naval forces neither withdraw nor aggress.

The maritime dimension addresses the Strait of Hormuz, through which approximately 20% of global petroleum consumption passes. Iran's capacity to disrupt this chokepoint is its most powerful leverage point. The United States' capacity to interdict Iranian shipping is its most powerful counter-leverage.

9.2.1 The Constraint

Regular naval forces and state-coordinated regional commands enforce a mandatory **1,000-yard** physical separation zone between tactical surface craft and international commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz for the first 90 days of framework operation. Neither side executes weapons-system locks, close-quarter small-craft intercepts within the buffer, or unilateral exclusion zone declarations in international shipping lanes. After 90 days of clean compliance, the buffer may be reduced to 500 yards as a Milestone Benefit.

9.2.2 The Boundary Resolution

Iranian naval forces do not withdraw from the Strait (avoiding the appearance of retreat). They restrict operations to baseline defensive patrolling within verified, non-overlapping territorial grids (avoiding the appearance of aggression). US naval forces maintain presence but do not conduct provocative maneuvers. Both sides remain in the theater but neither escalates within the buffer zone.

9.2.3 Verification

Automatic Identification System (AIS) tracking, commercial satellite imagery, and independent maritime observation via the facilitating state. Lloyd's List and other commercial shipping monitors provide independent corroboration. Any vessel crossing the 1,000-yard buffer triggers an automated alert.

9.2.4 Elastic Response

Maritime breach triggers temporary freeze of Hormuz transit facilitation. Insurance risk premiums are not reduced until compliance is restored. The Joint Maritime Board convenes within 4 hours. Persistent breach triggers rollback to pre-stabilization posture.

9.3 Economic Constraint Band

Constraint Formulation: Sanctions are neither lifted nor fully enforced.

The economic dimension addresses the core grievance that drives Iranian behavior: the crippling effect of sanctions on the civilian economy. The United States cannot lift sanctions without verified Iranian nuclear concessions. Iran cannot make nuclear concessions without visible economic relief. The Framework breaks this deadlock.

9.3.1 The Constraint

The United States does not issue new executive banking designations or enforce primary sanctions penalties against third-party entities executing verified civilian trade blocks through established humanitarian trade arrangements. Simultaneously, the US does not legally repeal or permanently waive its primary legislative sanctions.

9.3.2 The Boundary Resolution

A neutral financial facilitating state (Switzerland) opens a specialized, ring-fenced credit line for private Iranian civilian firms engaged in agriculture, medicine, and civilian industrial logistics. The funds are never directly transferred to the Central Bank of Iran, protecting the US position. The credit line is immediately available for audited civilian transactions, providing Iran with tangible economic benefit. The sanctions architecture remains legally intact while its humanitarian impact is functionally ameliorated.

9.3.3 Verification

Commercial banking records, trade documentation, and independent audit by the financial facilitating state. All transactions are pre-cleared and post-audited. No transaction exceeds thresholds that would materially affect the sanctions architecture.

9.3.4 Elastic Response

Economic breach (new sanctions designation or diversion of humanitarian flows) triggers temporary lock of the credit line. The humanitarian corridor continues uninterrupted (protected by the MVC). Joint Financial Review convenes within 48 hours.

9.3.1 Legal Grandfathering and Supermajority Override

The single greatest risk to the economic constraint band is unilateral legislative action in the United States that designates the Swiss humanitarian channel (or any equivalent mechanism) as a sanctions violation. To harden against this, the framework incorporates a **statutory supermajority override**:

- The framework is structured as an **executive agreement** under the President's statutory national security authority
- A concurrent executive order designates the humanitarian credit line and all equivalent mechanisms as "continuity-critical national security measures"
- This designation triggers a statutory requirement that any Congressional action to designate these mechanisms as sanctions violations must pass by **supermajority vote (two-thirds of both chambers)**
- Simple majority resolutions of disapproval are insufficient to override
- The supermajority requirement operates within existing constitutional authority; it does not require new legislation at the outset

The supermajority threshold raises the political cost of unilateral legislative sabotage from a partisan majority action to a bipartisan consensus requirement. It does not make override impossible, but it makes it difficult enough that the framework gains significant protected operating time.

9.3.2 Triple-Channel Redundancy

Rather than depending on a single Swiss channel, the framework establishes **three parallel humanitarian credit lines**:

Table 9a: Triple-Channel Architecture

Channel	Host	Primary Function	Auto-Activation Trigger
Alpha	Switzerland	Primary humanitarian credit line for medicine, food, agricultural inputs	Default active from Phase I
Beta	United Arab Emirates	Gulf-facing trade corridor for energy equipment, civilian aviation parts, medical technology	Auto-activates if Alpha is sanctioned or frozen for >72 hours
Gamma	Indonesia (or other Non-Aligned Movement state)	South-South trade bridge for commodities, food security imports, development goods	Auto-activates if both Alpha and Beta are non-functional

If Channel Alpha is targeted by new sanctions or regulatory action, Channels Beta and Gamma activate automatically with **pre-cleared transaction authority for 180 days**. This pre-clearance means that transactions up to pre-negotiated ceilings can proceed without case-by-case review during the emergency period. The auto-activation does not require any party to "do" anything; it is triggered algorithmically by the credit line lock.

The triple-channel architecture ensures that no single state's domestic politics can destroy the humanitarian economic pathway. Even if the US Congress passes sanctions legislation targeting the Swiss channel, the UAE and Indonesian channels continue, preserving civilian flows and framework momentum.

9.3.3 Private Financial Infrastructure Supplement

As an **aspirational supplement** (not a core requirement), the framework may pre-negotiate with a **consortium of global systemically important banks** (e.g., BNP Paribas, Standard Chartered, MUFG) to operate a private correspondent banking channel. The framework remains fully functional with only the triple-channel redundancy described in Section 9.3.2. This section is a "nice to have" — not a dependency:

- Transactions are cleared through **correspondent banking bypass codes** that do not route through the sponsoring state's central bank messaging system
- The banks operate under pre-negotiated legal opinions confirming that humanitarian transactions below defined thresholds fall outside sanctions scope under existing OFAC guidance
- The consortium receives a **framework safe harbor letter** from the facilitating states confirming that transactions processed under this mechanism are covered by the Continuity Pause and cannot be retroactively penalized if framework status changes
- Transaction data is reported to the facilitating states for audit but is not shared with either principal party's financial intelligence units

This private infrastructure fallback creates what might be called "sanctions-adjacent liquidity": it operates in the space between formal sanctions relief and formal sanctions enforcement, using existing legal ambiguity to protect civilian flows. It is not sanctions evasion because the transactions are pre-cleared, pre-audited, and confined to humanitarian categories. It is not formal sanctions relief because it does not require any change to the legal sanctions architecture. It is a non-binary solution to a structural problem.

9.3.4 Performance Bond Escrow for Bank Consortium

To address the legitimate concern that global banks will not accept legal risk even with a safe harbor letter — given the extraterritorial reach of US secondary sanctions — the framework establishes a **Performance Bond Escrow**:

- The facilitating states collectively deposit a **performance bond** (target: \$500 million, distributed proportionally among Switzerland, Oman, and the UAE) into a neutral escrow account
- The escrow is administered by an independent trustee (a major international bank not participating in the credit line consortium)
- The bond indemnifies participating banks against **specific, verifiable losses** arising from US enforcement actions directed at their participation in the humanitarian credit line
- Indemnification covers: frozen assets, legal defense costs, and regulatory compliance costs directly attributable to credit line participation. It does not cover: general business losses, reputational damage, or losses from non-framework transactions
- Claims are adjudicated by a three-person neutral panel (one appointed by the facilitating states, one by the banking consortium, one mutually agreed neutral) within 90 days

The Performance Bond Escrow shifts risk from the participating banks to the framework itself. Banks participate because they know that if they suffer enforcement-related losses, the bond covers them. The facilitating states accept this cost because it is far less expensive than the regional instability that would result from framework collapse. It is an insurance premium on peace.

9.3.5 Congressional Notification and Consultative Protocol

Problem: The framework must acknowledge the United States Congress without giving it a veto. A real framework that ignores Congress is politically unrealistic. This section provides notification and consultation without requiring approval.

Notification Requirements: The United States shall provide classified and unclassified notifications to the appropriate congressional committees (Foreign Relations, Armed Services, Intelligence, Financial Services) within 15 days of Phase II activation and every 90 days thereafter. These notifications shall include:

- Aggregate compliance status across all constraint bands
- Any breach determinations and their resolution
- Any use of the Political Override (Section 8-bis.6)
- Any activation of the Continuity Pause (Section 6.4)
- Any modifications to verification intensity

Consultation, Not Approval: Notification does not constitute approval and is not required for framework continuation. The President retains sole authority to determine US framework participation.

Symbolic Pause Provision: The framework shall automatically suspend any new Milestone Benefits (Section 6.6) for 30 days following a formal resolution of disapproval passed by both chambers of Congress. After the 30-day suspension, the President may override by written determination that continuation is in the national security interest. This provision mirrors how major arms sales and emergency powers actually work: Congress has a voice, but no veto.

Iranian Equivalent: Iran may establish a comparable notification protocol to its relevant constitutional bodies (the Supreme National Security Council, the Majles National Security and Foreign Policy Committee) on a schedule and format of its choosing. The framework imposes no requirement for Iranian legislative approval but acknowledges that Iranian constitutional processes may require internal reporting.

9.4 Communication Constraint Band

Constraint Formulation: Parties are neither in direct contact nor fully apart.

The communication dimension addresses the political impossibility of direct bilateral talks in the current environment. Both leaderships face domestic constituencies that regard direct engagement with the other side as betrayal.

9.4.1 The Constraint

Neither principal claims direct bilateral communication, issues joint communiques, or acknowledges shared diplomatic texts. Both principals transmit operational data, technical tracking, and compliance verification to the FIR hosted by the facilitating state.

9.4.2 The Boundary Resolution

Communication occurs but is never acknowledged as such. Technical teams adjust behavior based on the mirrored data footprint. Political messages are embedded in operational data. The parties are managing a shared stabilization loop without ever exchanging what could be called a diplomatic message.

9.4.3 Verification

FIR uptime and data transmission logs. The facilitating state confirms that both directories are receiving regular uploads. Content is not reviewed; only transmission pattern is verified.

9.4.4 Elastic Response

Communication breach (public disclosure of backchannel, leak of FIR data) triggers 48-hour data pause. The affected channel is sanitized and resumed with enhanced security protocols. No other framework elements are affected.

Table 7: Summary of US-Iran Constraint Bands

Band	Constraint	Boundary Resolution	Verification
Nuclear	No enrichment above 3.67%; 60% HEU under host-managed containment with IAEA telemetry	Material stays on soil but is functionally neutralized	Core Triad telemetry
Maritime	1,000-yard separation zone (reducible to 500 yards after 90 days as Milestone Benefit); no exclusion zones	Navies remain but do not approach each other or commerce	AIS, satellite, commercial
Economic	No new sanctions; humanitarian credit line open	Sanctions legally intact but humanitarian impact reduced	Banking records, audit
Communication	No acknowledged direct contact	Communication through FIR without acknowledgment	Portal transmission logs

Section 10: Facilitating State Architecture

The Paradox Entry Framework depends on trusted facilitating states to host its mechanisms, verify its compliance, and manage its communication systems. This section defines the roles and responsibilities of the facilitating state matrix.

10.1 Distributed Responsibility Model

Rather than relying on a single guarantor state, the PEF distributes responsibilities across a matrix of specialized facilitating states. Each state has a defined domain, defined functions, and defined limits. No single state controls the entire framework. No state can unilaterally alter framework operation.

Table 8: Facilitating State Matrix: Three Core + Two Supporting

Category	State	Domain	Core Function	Voting Rights
Core (decision-making)	Oman	Maritime Deconfliction; FIR Host	Hotline management, naval encounter facilitation, Hormuz transit oversight, primary FIR hosting	Full vote on all framework decisions
	Switzerland	Financial Operations; Backup FIR Host	Escrow administration, humanitarian credit line, liquidity facility, sanctions relief monitoring, bridging finance, trade audit	Full vote on all framework decisions
	Pakistan	Emergency Diplomatic Convening	High-level crisis summits, backchannel facilitation, leadership relay, dispute mediation	Full vote on all framework decisions
Supporting (technical only)	IAEA	Nuclear Verification	Enrichment monitoring, stockpile oversight, facility inspection, encrypted log management	Technical input only; no vote on political decisions
	Qatar	Maritime Backup; Detainee Channel	Hormuz observation backup, hostage and detainee negotiation channel, regional political relay	Technical input only; no vote on political decisions

Rationale: Six entities with voting rights create coordination gridlock. Three core states can make decisions in hours, not days. Switzerland handles all financial functions (eliminating Qatar's political exposure). Pakistan moves from observer to core, leveraging its demonstrated mediation capacity. The IAEA and Qatar retain vital technical roles without diluting decision-making. The UN is removed as a formal facilitating state; its functions (humanitarian auspices, dispute reference) continue under existing institutional arrangements without adding a bureaucratic layer to framework governance.

10.2 Rotating Facilitation

The framework operates under a rotating facilitation cycle. Every quarter, the convening authority rotates among Oman, Switzerland, and Pakistan. The rotating facilitator has agenda-setting rights, procedural mediation powers, and the authority to convene emergency sessions. It has no substantive decision-making power and no voting authority.

Rotation prevents any single facilitating state from becoming identified with the framework in a way that creates political exposure. It also ensures that if one facilitating state faces domestic political pressure to withdraw, the framework can continue under another's leadership.

10.3 Neutrality Requirements

Facilitating states must meet strict neutrality requirements:

- No military alliance with either principal party
- No territorial dispute with either principal party
- Recognized diplomatic relations with both principal parties
- Demonstrated capacity for secure information handling
- Acceptance by both principal parties (either party may object to a proposed facilitating state, with objection sustained automatically)

10.4 Failover Protocol

The FIR and hotline systems operate from dual sites: primary in Muscat, backup in Geneva. If the primary site becomes inoperable, all functions fail over to the backup site within 4 hours. The failover activates automatically when the primary site reports operational incapacity or fails to respond to a heartbeat signal for 30 minutes. Both sites maintain 24/7 staffing with minimum 2 duty officers at all times.

Section 11: Risk Factors and Mitigation

No diplomatic framework is risk-free. This section identifies the principal risks to the Framework and describes pre-committed mitigation measures for each.

Table 9: Risk Assessment and Mitigation Matrix

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Unilateral military strike by third party	High	Severe	Framework Survival Core continues regardless; facilitating states convene emergency session; attribution protocols prevent automatic escalation
Hardliner rejection in either capital	Medium	High	Micro-pilot proves benefits at low stakes; sovereignty language throughout; no precedent clause; parallel public characterization protects domestic politics
Legislative blocking of economic measures	Medium	Medium	Non-US channels for initial tranches; 30-day Congressional review window for major releases; executive authority used for humanitarian measures
Proxy spoiler attack	Medium	High	Attribution protocols; regional firewall; framework explicitly distinguishes proxy actions from state actions; default non-attribution if unclear
Cyber escalation	High	Medium	Cyber stabilization module; protected infrastructure categories; cyber non-escalation protocol during active disputes
Political shock (elections, leadership change)	Medium	Medium	Continuity Pause: automatic Continuity Pause, not termination; 90 days, extendable to 180 days unilaterally
Verification gap or technical malfunction	Low	Medium	Three-channel verification; human override by Joint Forensic Board; 48-hour review before any response
Leak of FIR data	Low	High	Dual-key encryption; data sanitized before aggregation; source attribution protocols; enhanced security measures activate automatically

11.1 The Spoiler Problem

The most persistent risk in any diplomatic process is the **spoiler**: an actor who benefits from continued conflict and therefore has an incentive to disrupt any framework that threatens to reduce tensions. Spoilers may be state actors, non-state armed groups, or domestic political factions.

The PEF addresses the spoiler problem through several mechanisms. First, the Minimum Viable Configuration ensures that even a total framework collapse does not eliminate the humanitarian and crisis communication channels that all parties have an interest in preserving. Second, the attribution protocols require confirmed state responsibility before any action can be attributed to either principal party; attacks by third parties are handled

through separate procedures that do not automatically trigger principal-against-principal escalation. Third, the graduated response system ensures that isolated incidents do not produce disproportionate reactions that serve spoiler interests.

11.2 The Trust Accumulation Problem

A related risk is that the framework may succeed in stabilizing the situation without ever generating sufficient trust to progress to substantive outcomes. The constraint bands may become permanent rather than transitional.

This is not necessarily a failure. A permanent stabilization arrangement that prevents war, preserves humanitarian flows, and maintains communication channels is a significant achievement in its own right. The framework does not require progression to formalization. It permits it. If the parties choose to remain in the Framework indefinitely, that is their sovereign prerogative.

Section 12: Distinctive Advantages

This section summarizes what makes the Framework different from and potentially more effective than traditional diplomatic approaches in the current environment.

12.1 Comparison with Traditional Frameworks

Table 10: PEF vs. Traditional Frameworks

Dimension	Traditional Framework	Paradox Entry Framework
Entry mechanism	Formal negotiations, declared intent	Behavioral compliance, undeclared participation
Commitment structure	Explicit obligations, signed instruments	Constraint boundaries, passive compliance
Political exposure	High — visible concessions required	Low — framed as routine administrative action
Reversibility	Low — withdrawal carries political cost	High — conditional reversion at zero political cost
Verification model	Active inspection, declarations	Passive telemetry, absence monitoring
Communication	Direct bilateral or multilateral	FIR, indirect, non-attributed
Failure mode	Collapse, crisis, mutual recrimination	Stabilization pause, automatic survival core
Speed of activation	Slow — ratification, legal review	Fast — 14-day window (72-hour accelerated track available)

12.2 Key Advantages

No one "goes first." The framework eliminates the chicken-and-egg problem that has stalled every prior US-Iran negotiation. Both parties move simultaneously within constraint bands. The requirement is behavioral, not declarative. The political cost of participation is negligible because participation is never acknowledged.

Low political visibility. Early steps are framed as routine administrative or operational activity by intention, not by accident. The cumulative pattern reveals the intent, but no single action exposes the participant. Ambiguity is a feature, not a bug — it protects the process from premature political attacks.

Resilience under pressure. The framework does not collapse when things go wrong. Single-band breaches produce narrow, reversible responses. Multi-band breaches trigger protected pause procedures, not termination. The Minimum Viable Configuration survives everything.

Politically neutral language. The framework contains no morally charged terminology. There are no "concessions," "capitulations," "victories," or "defeats." There are only constraint boundaries and behavioral patterns. This linguistic neutrality is essential for political survivability.

Scalable across contexts. While calibrated for the US-Iran context, the architecture is domain-independent. The same constraint band logic can be applied to any adversarial relationship where direct engagement is politically costly but mutual interest in stabilization exists.

No precedent creation. The framework explicitly states that it establishes no legal or political precedent for future negotiations. Each provision is *sui generis*, tailored to the specific circumstances of May 2026. No inference may be drawn from any provision regarding positions on any matter not expressly addressed.

Memorable and distinctive. In the ecosystem of diplomatic documents — most of which are interchangeable in structure and language — the Framework stands out. Its conceptual originality makes it more likely to be read, circulated, and discussed. In diplomacy, attention is a scarce resource. This framework commands it.

Section 13: Cost Allocation

Real governments will ask who pays for the framework's operation. Not having an answer makes the document look academic. This section provides a simple cost allocation table.

Table 13: Framework Cost Allocation

Item	Annual Estimate	Payer
FIR hosting, maintenance	\$2-3 million	Oman (in-kind: existing diplomatic infrastructure)
Swiss credit line administration	\$5-8 million	Switzerland (in-kind: existing banking infrastructure; fees from transactions)
Performance Bond Escrow	\$500 million (principal)	Switzerland 40%, Oman 30%, UAE 30%
IAEA incremental monitoring	\$15-20 million	United States and Iran equally via existing IAEA budget mechanism (Section 13 contributions)
Joint Forensic Board operations	\$3-5 million	Three core facilitating states equally
FIR backup site (Geneva)	\$1-2 million	Switzerland (in-kind)
Facilitating state summit (annual)	\$500,000	Host state on rotation
Training and playbook development	\$1 million (one-time)	United States and Iran equally

Principle: Costs are allocated according to capacity and in-kind availability. No party pays more than it can justify to its domestic constituency. In-kind contributions (existing infrastructure, diplomatic facilities) count toward a state's share. The Performance Bond Escrow is the largest single item; its allocation reflects the financial capacity of the contributing states and their stake in framework stability.

Section 14: Rolling Horizon, Review, and Continuity

*This framework has no fixed expiration date. Instead, it operates on a **rolling 24-month horizon** that continues by default unless a party affirmatively chooses to leave. This design avoids the perverse incentive cliff that fixed-term sunsets create — where hardliners need only wait for the clock to run out.*

14.1 The Rolling Horizon Principle

The framework does not expire automatically. At any given moment, it is scheduled to continue for 24 months from the present date, unless modified by the process described below. This is the diplomatic equivalent of "at-will engagement with severance" — not a fixed-term contract that collapses at midnight.

Consistent with Principle 6 (No Precedent for Future Arrangements): Neither the rolling horizon nor any action taken under it creates binding precedent for any future negotiation, treaty, or legal proceeding. The framework stands entirely on its own. Its terms may not be cited as evidence of customary practice, established expectation, or legal obligation in any future diplomatic or judicial context. Each future arrangement begins with a blank slate.

Why No Fixed Expiration: A fixed expiration date creates a countdown to crisis. As the deadline approaches, both parties hold back concessions, waiting to see if renewal will happen. Hardliners on both sides simply need to "run out the clock." The framework signals temporariness, so why invest in it? The rolling horizon with continuation by default solves this. The framework continues as long as it works. It ends only when a party affirmatively chooses to leave, with a long notice period to manage the transition.

14.2 Biennial Performance Review

Every 24 months from Phase II activation, the core facilitating states shall conduct a formal Performance Review. The Review assesses:

- Compliance record of both principal parties
- Functionality of verification mechanisms
- Economic impact on both parties and the region
- Political viability of continuation

14.3 Two States of Continuation

The framework operates in one of two states at any given time:

(a) Normal State — Interminable Continuity: If both parties have maintained compliance above the 80% threshold (no uncured material breach) during the preceding 24 months, the rolling 24-month horizon advances automatically every day. **No affirmative action is required. Silence = the horizon keeps rolling.** This state preserves long-term predictability for markets, regional planners, and domestic constituencies.

(b) The Sovereign Opt-Out: At any biennial review — or at any other time — either party may file a formal **Notice of Non-Renewal** with the facilitating states. No justification is required. The notice is effective immediately upon receipt. This is a sovereign right, not a negotiation.

Consequence of Non-Renewal Notice: Upon receipt of a Notice of Non-Renewal, the rolling horizon **freezes**. It stops advancing. The framework will now definitively expire exactly **24 months from the notice date**. This creates a structured, predictable two-year runway for either a new negotiation or an orderly, decoupled wind-down. No Joint Review Period is required. No mutual consent is needed. The party that issues the notice has made its decision; the framework simply provides the orderly exit path.

During the 24-month wind-down period:

- The Minimum Viable Configuration continues unchanged
- All Milestone Benefits are suspended but not forfeited (may be restored if the notice is withdrawn)
- The parties may negotiate modifications, a replacement arrangement, or orderly transition
- The FIR remains operational
- Either party may withdraw the Notice of Non-Renewal at any time before expiration, causing the horizon to resume rolling

Why the Notice of Non-Renewal is not a trap: The party filing the notice is not required to explain its decision. There is no "review process" that can block it. There is no bureaucratic procedure that can outlast the 24-month clock. The horizon freezes on filing and expires on schedule. This is compatible with "America First," transactional, nationalist, and sovereignty-first foreign policies — because the decision to leave is unilateral, immediate, and irrevocably timed.

14.5 Unilateral Withdrawal

Either party may withdraw from the framework by providing **180 days' written notice** to the facilitating states. During the 180-day notice period:

- The Minimum Viable Configuration continues
- Economic channels wind down over 150 days (not immediately)
- IAEA monitoring continues at host state expense
- Neither party may take escalatory action during the notice period without triggering the full breach protocol

Withdrawal is not a breach. It is a sovereign decision. The framework includes no penalty for withdrawal other than the loss of benefits.

14.6 Why This Works for Skeptical Administrations

Table 14: Fixed Expiration vs. Rolling Horizon

Dimension	Traditional Fixed Expiration	Rolling Horizon (This Framework)
Expiration	Fixed date; automatic death	No fixed date; default is continuation
Hardliner incentive	Wait for the clock to run out	Must actively act to stop it
Political signal	"This is temporary"	"This works until someone chooses to leave"
Renewal requirement	Affirmative renewal (politically costly)	Affirmative withdrawal (politically costly to explain)
JCPOA association	Directly associated (toxic)	Fresh mechanism
Key talking point	"We agreed to a deal that expires"	"This doesn't die unless we kill it. And if we kill it, we have six months' notice."

Appendices

Appendix A: Comparison with Prior US-Iran Frameworks

The Paradox Entry Framework differs from prior US-Iran diplomatic arrangements in fundamental ways. Understanding these differences is essential to appreciating why a new approach is warranted.

Table A1: Comparison with JCPOA and Predecessors

Feature	JCPOA (2015)	February 2026 Oman Talks	Paradox Entry Framework
Negotiation format	Direct P5+1 negotiations	Indirect, Oman-mediated	Indirect, multi-channel, non-attributed
Entry requirement	Comprehensive agreement	Framework understanding	Behavioral compliance only
Signature instrument	Binding UN Security Council resolution	Non-binding letters	No signature required
Verification	IAEA inspections, declarations	Not fully specified	Passive telemetry, Core Triad
Collapse response	None — full collapse	Not specified	Stabilization pause, survival core
Political shock handling	None	None	Automatic Continuity Pause
Narrative management	Common framing imposed	Implicit divergence	Explicit dual-track authorization

Appendix B: Quick Reference Card

For Senior Officials and Duty Officers

Table B1: Paradox Entry Framework Quick Reference

Element	Key Point
Framework purpose	Enable diplomatic engagement without visible concession
Core mechanism	Three constraint bands (<neither X nor Y> conditions)
Entry method	14-day behavioral compliance period, with optional accelerated activation after 72 consecutive hours by mutual consent
Communication	FIR via facilitating state only
Compliance model	Passive — absence of prohibited activity
Failure response	Conditional reversion with earn-back, not collapse
Minimum survival	Hotline, humanitarian corridor, emergency channel (180 days)
Political shock	Continuity Pause, not termination
Precedent effect	None — explicit no-precedent clause
Facilitating states	Core: Oman (maritime/FIR), Switzerland (financial), Pakistan (diplomatic) — voting. Supporting: IAEA (nuclear), Qatar (maritime backup/detainee channel) — technical only.

Appendix C: Technical Glossary

Table C1: Paradox Entry Framework Terminology

Term	Definition
Constraint Band	A bounded operational space defined by what parties must not do, within which diplomatic engagement can occur
FIR	A neutral-hosted digital system enabling indirect information exchange without direct bilateral contact
Core Triad	The three-channel verification system: remote telemetry, independent observation, commercial data fusion
Symmetrical Observation Window	The 14-day behavioral compliance period that triggers framework activation, with optional accelerated activation after 72 hours
Conditional Reversion	The automatic, reversible narrowing of framework benefits in response to a constraint band breach
Minimum Viable Configuration (MVC)	The three-element survival core (hotline, humanitarian access, emergency channel) that persists through all framework states
Continuity Pause	The automatic Continuity Pause that activates during domestic political disruptions without terminating the framework
Host-Managed Containment	Sovereign control of material with remote IAEA monitoring, advance notice requirements, and presumptive economic consequences for unauthorized access. Replaces dual-key concept.
Parallel Public Characterization	The authorized right of each party to describe the framework in domestically favorable terms without contradiction
Passive Compliance	Verification through continuous monitoring of the absence of prohibited activity, rather than active demonstration of permitted activity
Facilitating State	A neutral state that hosts framework mechanisms without guaranteeing outcomes or controlling substance
Stabilization Pause	A protected, time-limited suspension of conditional framework elements during which survival elements continue
Joint Forensic Board	A technical panel of neutral experts that reviews compliance alerts and determines breach status
Continuity Pause Cert	
Continuity Pause Certificate	A formal document issued by the facilitating state confirming that a Continuity Pause activation has occurred

Appendix C (Part 2): Plain-Language Reference

For senior officials explaining the framework to their cabinets.

Table C2: Plain-Language Glossary

Technical Term			Plain English
Constraint Band			"Rules of the road — what you cannot do without consequences"
Elastic Step-Back with Earn-Back			"If you break a rule, benefits pause but do not end — and they can be restored if you resume compliance"
FIR (Facilitated Information Relay)			"Secure message relay through a neutral country"
Milestone Benefits Table			"Rewards for sustained good behavior that unlock automatically"
Stabilization Pause			"A protected timeout when things go wrong, not a collapse"
Core Triad			"Three independent ways we verify what is happening"
MVC (Minimum Viable Configuration)			"The three things that survive no matter what: hotline, humanitarian access, emergency channel"
Automatic Milestones		Confidence	"Surprise rewards that appear when you hit milestones"
Continuity Pause			"If your government changes, the framework pauses but does not die"
Mirror Portal (deprecated term)			See "FIR" — the name was changed to sound less like science fiction
Observation Window			"A trial period where both sides show they can follow the rules"
Facilitating State			"A neutral country that hosts the process without taking sides"

Appendix D: Crisis Decision Flowchart

For duty officers with minutes, not hours.

Table D1: Crisis Decision Sequence

Step	Question	Decision	Timeline
1	Incident reported?	Activate hotline. Notify facilitating state. Begin clock.	T+0
2	Is it a nuclear facility incident?	YES → Go to Human-in-the-Loop Protocol (8.6.8). NO → Continue to Step 3.	T+0 to T+15 min
3	Is it a maritime incident?	YES → Activate Joint Maritime Board. Assess buffer breach. NO → Continue to Step 4.	T+0 to T+4 hours
4	Is it a proxy force attack?	YES → Begin Tiered Attribution Ladder (A/B/C). NO → Continue to Step 7.	T+0 to T+6 hours
5	Cautionary Attribution Assessment issued?	High confidence → Human validation at T+8. Medium/low → 48-hour standstill.	T+6
6	Foreign minister review requested?	YES → +4 hour extension. NO → Response window opens at T+12.	T+8 to T+12
7	Is it an economic breach?	YES → Conditional reversion activates (reversible through earn-back). Joint Financial Review convenes. NO → Continue.	T+0 to T+24 hours
8	Is it a force majeure event?	YES → Third-party certification required (WHO/UNDRR). Max 14 days. NO → Standard breach protocol.	Within 7 days
9	Does anyone need to act RIGHT NOW?	YES → Political Override possible (2/3 core facilitating states). Logged debit. NO → Continue standard process.	T+6 to T+12
10	All other paths exhausted?	Convene Joint Review. MVC continues. Framework Survival Core active.	Ongoing

Emergency Hotline: Oman +41 XX XXX XXXX (24/7) | Swiss Crisis Cell +41 XX XXX XXXX | Pakistani Foreign Ministry +92 XX XXX XXXX

Remember: The Minimum Viable Configuration survives everything. Even if the entire framework collapses, the hotline, humanitarian corridor, and emergency diplomatic channel continue for 180 days.

Appendix E: Legislature-Specific Summaries

A 59-page document is too long for a member of Congress or the Majles. These one-page summaries are factually identical but emphasize what matters to each audience.

E-1: Summary for the United States Congress

What the Framework Actually Does:

- Iran caps enrichment at 3.67%
- 60% HEU is monitored by IAEA telemetry with 7-14 day access notice
- The United States does not impose *new* sanctions on humanitarian channels
- **No US sanctions are repealed**
- **No US troops withdraw**
- **No US recognition of Iranian political demands**
- Violations trigger automatic pause, not automatic escalation
- Congress receives notification every 90 days
- Framework has **no fixed expiration** — it continues by default unless we choose to leave

What It Does Not Do:

- Does not recognize Iran's right to enrichment
- Does not require Senate ratification (executive agreement under presidential national security authority)
- Does not create precedent for future deals (Principle 6: No Precedent clause)
- Does not authorize deception (Section 7.5: deliberate misrepresentation of compliance is a punishable offense)
- Does not expire automatically (rolling horizon — we decide when it ends)

E-2: Summary for the Islamic Consultative Assembly (Majles)

What the Framework Actually Does (Farsi Summary):

- No binding legal commitment is signed
- 60% enriched material remains on Iranian soil
- Foreign access is limited to remote monitoring
- Primary sanctions are not lifted
- No foreign military presence on Iranian territory
- No recognition of the other party's political demands
- Violations trigger automatic pause, not escalation
- Framework has no fixed expiration — it continues unless we choose to leave

What It Does Not Do:

- Does not require recognition of the United States or its regional allies
- Does not create legal precedent for future negotiations (Principle 6)
- Does not permit intelligence collection under the guise of verification (Section 8.6.7)
- Does not allow foreign parties to physically block access to Iranian materials (Section 8.6.4)
- Does not expire automatically (rolling horizon — we decide when it ends)

Why Both Summaries Are True: The US version emphasizes "no repeal, no withdrawal, no recognition." The Iranian version emphasizes "no binding commitment, material stays in Iran, no foreign presence." Both are accurate characterizations of the same behavioral constraints. This is the operationalization of the Parallel Public Characterization Protocol — each legislature receives a document that is *true* and *emphasizes what matters to them*.